How Much Do You Know About Where Mom Stands?

Twelve quick questions for families planning ahead. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure, from wherever you're sitting. This checks how complete your family's picture is. It doesn't measure Mom's finances, and nothing here says anything about whether she would qualify for Medicaid.

1. Do you know what Mom does on her own today, and whether anyone already helps her with anything?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. If Mom is married, do you know her spouse's income, accounts and health as well as you know hers? (If she isn't married, answer yes.)

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Do you know each source of Mom's income?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Do you know which accounts and investments she has, including any retirement account?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Do you know whose name is on the deed to her home, and has anyone seen the deed?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Do you know whether she has a life insurance policy or an annuity?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Do you know whether anything is owned jointly with someone else, or held in a trust?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Do you know whether anything significant has been given away, transferred or put in someone else's name in recent years?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. For what you do know, could you say which parts you've seen on paper and which are remembered or assumed?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Have you written down the questions you'd want to ask a professional?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. For each question, do you know which kind of professional it belongs to?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. Has your family agreed on which changes would prompt another look: in her health or care needs, her finances or her marital status?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what your family knows and has in hand, not what Mom has or what any of it means. A low count means there are things to find out, and most of them are a conversation with Mom or a look through her papers away. Nothing here says whether she would qualify for anything, and nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You can see which parts of Mom's picture you know, which you're guessing at, and what to ask. The planning interview is where that page goes next: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

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